



"I accept your wager," said the giant. "And look forward to tearing off your head and kicking it into the sea!" And this giant – whose name was Hrungrnir, or "brawler" – meant what he said.

*So Hrungrnir mounted his horse, called Gullfaxi, which means "golden mane". The giant and the god raced through field, fen and forest striking sparks and kicking stones as the land swept by in a blur.*

Before they knew it, they'd barrelled into Asgard and come to a panting, sweating, skidding halt in front of the drinking hall.

"Looks like I'll keep my head," a victorious Odin said. "But be a good sport and drink with us."

The Aesir welcomed Hrungrnir and gave him so much ale he became drunk and very bad tempered.

"You lot think you're so much better than us giants," he bellowed. "I've a mind to kill you all and smash Asgard into rubble!"

Odin leaned close to Heimdall. "I'm tired of this boorish giant. Go fetch Thor from the mountains."



*Hrungrnir was welcomed by the Aesir and drank lots of ale.*